

Here's the full curation for **cup**, anchored to the passage sentence **"Once, she used nothing more than a cup, a torch, and a shadow on the wall..."** The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

CUP

1. Passage anchor

> "Once, she used nothing more than a **cup**, a torch, and a shadow on the wall to explain a difficult idea about light..."

Passage meaning

cup = a small drinking container, usually with an open top and often a handle

杯子；茶杯；咖啡杯

Here, Ms. Lau uses an ordinary physical **cup** as a classroom object in a physics demonstration.

Practice

1. She placed a **cup** in front of the torch.

她把一個**杯子**放在手電筒前面。

2. The shadow changed when she moved the **cup** closer to the light.

當她把**杯子**移近光源時，影子發生了變化。

Core meanings of CUP

2. cup — drinking container

= a small container used for drinking, usually with an open top and often a handle

杯子；茶杯；咖啡杯

Examples

1. She poured tea into a **cup**.

她把茶倒進一個**杯子**裡。

2. He left his coffee **cup** on the desk.

他把咖啡**杯**留在桌上。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. cup of + drink

= the amount of a drink contained in one cup

一杯.....

Examples

1. I'd like a **cup of tea**.

我想要**一杯茶**。

2. She drank two **cups of coffee**.

她喝了兩**杯咖啡**。

This is a container-to-content extension.

Measurement

4. cup — unit of volume

= a cooking measure equal to one cupful; the exact volume depends on the measurement system

杯；量杯單位

Examples

1. Add one **cup of flour**.

加一**杯麵粉**。

2. The recipe calls for half a **cup of sugar**.

這個食譜需要半**杯糖**。

This is a major distinct sense.

5. measuring cup

= container marked for measuring liquid or dry ingredients

量杯

Examples

1. Use a **measuring cup** for the milk.

用**量杯**量牛奶。

2. She poured the water into a **measuring cup**.
她把水倒進**量杯**裡。

Trophy / prize

6. cup — trophy awarded in a competition

= a trophy, often cup-shaped, given to the winner of a competition
獎盃 ; 盃

Examples

1. The team won the **cup**.
球隊贏得了**獎盃 / 盃賽冠軍**。

2. She lifted the **cup** after the final.
她在決賽後舉起了**獎盃**。

7. Cup — competition

= a sports competition whose winner receives a cup or trophy
盃賽

Examples

1. They reached the **Cup final**.
他們打進了**盃賽決賽**。

2. The club was knocked out of the **Cup**.
那支球隊在**盃賽**中被淘汰。

Often capitalized when part of an official competition name.

Shape / hollow form

8. cup — cup-shaped hollow or cavity

= a small hollow, curved, or cup-shaped structure
杯狀凹槽 ; 杯狀物

Examples

1. The flower has a deep **cup**.
這朵花有一個深的**杯狀花冠**。
2. The object fits into a small **cup-shaped hollow**.
這個物體可放入一個小型**杯狀凹槽**。

More technical/lower priority.

Clothing / anatomy

9. cup — bra cup

= one of the two shaped parts of a bra that support the breasts
罩杯

Examples

1. The bra comes in several **cup sizes**.
這款胸罩有多種**罩杯尺寸**。
2. She checked the correct **cup size**.
她確認了正確的**罩杯尺寸**。

10. cup size

= size classification of the cup of a bra
罩杯尺寸

Examples

1. **Cup size** is only one part of bra sizing.
罩杯尺寸只是胸罩尺寸的一部分。
2. The store offers a wide range of **cup sizes**.
這家店提供多種**罩杯尺寸**。

Sports equipment

11. cup — hole/container in golf

= the small hole in the putting green into which the ball is played

****高爾夫球洞；球杯****

Examples

1. The ball stopped just short of the ****cup****.

球停在離****球洞****很近的地方。

2. He rolled the ball into the ****cup****.

他把球推進了****球洞****。

Specialist sports sense.

Medical / protective equipment

12. cup — protective or collecting device

In some compounds, ****cup**** refers to a shaped protective or collecting container.

Examples include:

* protective cup

* suction cup

The exact Chinese depends on the compound.

13. suction cup

= rubber/plastic cup-shaped device that sticks to a surface by suction

****吸盤****

Examples

1. The hook attaches with a ****suction cup****.

掛鉤用****吸盤****固定。

2. The ****suction cup**** stuck firmly to the glass.

****吸盤****牢牢吸在玻璃上。

Verb: form hands into a cup shape

14. cup your hands

= curve your hands together into a hollow shape

把雙手合成杯狀；用手捧著

Examples

1. She **cupped her hands** around the candle.
她用雙手**攏住蠟燭**。
2. He **cupped his hands** to catch the water.
他把雙手**捧成杯狀**接水。

15. cup something in your hands

= hold something gently in curved hands

用雙手捧著

Examples

1. She **cupped the bird in her hands**.
她用雙手**輕輕捧著那隻鳥**。
2. He **cupped his face in his hands**.
他用雙手**捧著臉**。

Cupping / medical practice

16. cupping

= therapy using cups placed on the skin to create suction

拔罐

Examples

1. The clinic offers **cupping therapy**.
診所提供**拔罐療法**。

2. **Cupping** creates suction on the skin.

拔罐會在皮膚上形成吸力。

This is a distinct derivative use.

Fixed expressions

17. not my cup of tea

= not something you enjoy or are interested in

不是我的興趣；不是我喜歡的類型

Examples

1. Horror films are **not my cup of tea**.

恐怖片**不是我的菜**。

2. Competitive sports are **not really my cup of tea**.

競技運動**不太是我的興趣**。

Very common idiom, especially in British English.

18. a storm in a teacup

= a lot of unnecessary excitement or anger about a small issue

小題大作；茶杯裡的風暴

Examples

1. The argument was just **a storm in a teacup**.

那場爭論只是**小題大作**。

2. What seemed serious at first turned out to be **a storm in a teacup**.

一開始看起來很嚴重，結果只是**一場小題大作**。

BrE; AmE more often uses **tempest in a teapot**.

Related forms

19. cupful

= amount a cup can contain

****一杯的量****

Examples

1. Add one ****cupful**** of water.

加****一杯量的水****。

2. She drank a ****cupful**** of soup.

她喝了****一杯湯****。

Lower priority than ****a cup of****.

20. cup-shaped

= shaped like a cup

****杯狀的****

Examples

1. The flower has a ****cup-shaped**** center.

這朵花中央呈****杯狀****。

2. The device has a ****cup-shaped**** base.

這個裝置有一個****杯狀底座****。

Countability

21. cup is countable

* a cup

* two cups

* several cups

Examples

1. There is a ****cup**** on the table.

桌上有一個****杯子****。

2. We need four ****cups****.

我們需要四個****杯子****。

Key contrasts

22. cup vs mug

****cup****

= usually smaller drinking vessel, often with a handle; common for tea/coffee

****杯子 ; 茶杯****

****mug****

= usually larger, deeper, sturdier drinking vessel with a handle

****馬克杯 ; 大杯子****

Compare:

> a teacup

> 茶杯

> a coffee mug

> 馬克杯

23. cup vs glass

****cup****

= typically opaque container, often with a handle

****glass****

= drinking container usually made of glass and without a handle

****玻璃杯****

Compare:

> a cup of tea

> 一杯茶

> a glass of water

> 一杯水

The distinction is usually about container type, not the liquid itself.

24. cup vs bowl

****cup****

= smaller, deeper vessel typically for drinking

****bowl****

= wider open container typically for food

****碗****

Compare:

> a cup of soup

> 一杯湯

> a bowl of soup

> 一碗湯

25. cup vs trophy

****trophy****

= any prize object awarded for achievement

****獎盃；獎品****

****cup****

= a particular trophy type, and by extension sometimes the competition itself

So:

> win a trophy

> 贏得獎盃

> win the Cup

> 贏得盃賽冠軍

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****cup**** is:

****a small hollow container****

From this develop:

Drinking vessel

cup

→ **杯子**

Quantity

a cup of flour

→ **一杯的量**

Trophy

cup

→ **獎盃**

Sports competition

the Cup

→ **盃賽**

Shape

cup-shaped

→ **杯狀**

Bra

cup

→ **罩杯**

Golf

cup

→ **球洞**

Verb

cup your hands

→ **雙手捧成杯狀**

Idiom

not my cup of tea

→ **不是我的興趣 / 不是我的菜**

The passage uses the simplest literal branch:

****an ordinary physical drinking cup used as a teaching prop.****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cup — drinking container	用來盛飲料的小型容器，通常有杯口並常帶把手；杯子
a cup of + drink/food	一杯某種飲料或食物的量
cup — measurement	烹飪中以一杯為單位的容量量度
measuring cup	用來量取液體或食材容量的量杯
cup — trophy	比賽頒給優勝者的獎盃
the Cup — competition	以獎盃為象徵的盃賽 / 淘汰賽事
cup — cup-shaped hollow	呈杯狀的凹槽、結構或部分
cup — bra	胸罩中承托胸部的罩杯
cup size	胸罩罩杯大小的尺寸分類
cup — golf	高爾夫果嶺上的球洞 / 球杯
suction cup	利用吸力附著在表面的吸盤
cup your hands	把雙手彎曲合攏成杯狀
cup something in your hands	用彎曲的雙手輕輕捧住某物
cupping	利用杯具形成吸力的拔罐療法
not my cup of tea	不是自己喜歡、感興趣或擅長的事物
a storm in a teacup	因小事引起過度反應；小題大作
cupful	一個杯子可盛裝的量
cup-shaped	外形像杯子的；杯狀的

Passage recap

> “Once, she used nothing more than a ****cup****, a torch, and a shadow on the wall...”

Here:

****cup**** = ****an ordinary drinking container****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****杯子****

* contextually: ****一個普通杯子****

Natural contextual translation:

****有一次，她只用了一個杯子、一支手電筒和牆上的影子……****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

cup

= **a small container used for drinking**

杯子；茶杯；咖啡杯

The key polysemy contrasts are:

> a **cup of tea**

> → 一杯茶

> one **cup of flour**

> → 一杯量的麵粉

> win the **Cup**

> → 贏得盃賽 / 獎盃

> **not my cup of tea**

> → 不是我的興趣 / 不是我的菜

But in the passage, it is simply the literal **physical cup** used in the demonstration.